THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

Revision Notes

Class 6 · Social Science

Exploring Society: India and Beyond — Chapters 8 to 14 · CBSE / RBSE Syllabus

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Each chapter follows the textbook's own order of sections, so you can read straight through. Bold words are keywords you must be able to define. Tables compare and classify; shaded boxes hold definitions, formulas and key facts. The navy Key Takeaways box at the end of every chapter is your last-two-minutes revision.

CH.	CHAPTER TITLE	CORE THEME
8	Unity in Diversity	India's diversity and underlying unity
9	Family and Community	Family types, roles, community and interdependence
10	Grassroots Democracy – Part 1: Governance	Governance, three organs, three levels, democracy
11	Grassroots Democracy – Part 2: Local Government in Rural Areas	Panchayati Raj: Gram Panchayat, Samiti, Zila Parishad
12	Grassroots Democracy – Part 3: Local Government in Urban Areas	Urban local bodies, wards, municipal corporations
13	The Value of Work	Economic vs non-economic activities, value addition
14	Economic Activities Around Us	Primary, secondary and tertiary sectors; AMUL

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CHAPTER 08 · HISTORY / CULTURE

Unity in Diversity

India shows enormous variety in landscapes, languages, dress, food, festivals and stories — yet a deep unity runs through it. This chapter explains 'unity in diversity' through food, textiles, festivals, the two epics and the Pañchatantra: the same basic ingredients, ideas and stories appear in countless forms.

Big Questions

- What is meant by 'unity in diversity' in the Indian scenario?
- What aspects of India's diversity are the most striking?
- How do we make out the unity underlying the diversity?

8.1 A Rich Diversity

- Travelling across India you see changing landscapes, dresses, food, languages and scripts. India has **over 1.4 billion** people (about **18%** of the world).
- The **Anthropological Survey of India's 'People of India' project** (late 20th century) studied **4,635 communities**, counted **325 languages** in **25 scripts**, and found many Indians are **migrants** living away from their birthplace or original community. (Directed by anthropologist **K.S. Singh**.)
- Historian **Vincent Smith** asked how a history of India could be written given such 'bewildering diversity' — his answer: India offers **unity in diversity**.
- Quotations: **Tagore** — never lose 'the touch of the one in the play of the many'; **Sri Aurobindo** — 'the Many in the One' is India's own nature (*swabhāva* and *swadharma*).

DEFINITION

Unity in diversity — many different forms, customs and languages existing together while sharing common basic elements, values and stories. Diversity does not divide; it **enriches**.

8.2 Food for All

- Thousands of dishes exist, yet certain **staple grains** are common nearly everywhere: **cereals** (rice, barley, wheat), **millets** (bajra/pearl millet, jowar/sorghum, ragi/finger millet) and **pulses** (dals, rajma, chana, moong, masoor, arhar, lobia).
- Common **spices**: turmeric, cumin, cardamom, ginger — also common vegetables and oils.
- **Same ingredients (unity) in many combinations (diversity)** = an endless variety of dishes.

8.3 Textiles and Clothing

- Every region has its own styles but there are common forms — the **sari**, a plain **unstitched** length of cloth worn across India in cotton, silk and now synthetics.
- Famous silk saris: **Banarasi, Kanjivaram, Paithani, Patan Patola, Muga, Mysore**. Hundreds of varieties arise from different weaving methods, designs (woven in or printed later) and pigments.
- The sari is old: a stone relief from **Vaiśhali (Bihar)** shows it a few centuries BCE. Travellers marvelled at its simplicity, economy and many ways of draping; women use it for many other purposes too.
- India produced the **finest cotton** in the world; **chintz** (printed cotton) became so popular in 17th-century Europe that local dress sales fell, and **England and France banned its import**.

- The **dhoti** is another example: one garment, many styles and uses.

Unity: one garment, the sari. **Diversity:** fabrics, weaves, designs, colours and drapes.

8.4 Festivals Galore

- Many festivals are celebrated across India at about the same time under different names. Example: **Makara Sankrānti** (around **14 January**), marking the start of the harvest season in many parts.
- Regional names: **Pongal / Makara Vilakku** (south), **Magh Bihu** (Assam), **Maghi / Lohri** (Punjab), **Uttarayan** (Gujarat), **Khichdi Parv**, **Poush Sankranti**, **Shishur Saenkraat** (Kashmir), **Pedda Panduga** (Andhra), **Makara Sankramana** (Karnataka), etc.
- October–November also brings many major festivals with different local names.

8.5 An Epic Spread

Epic	Story in brief	Values
Mahābhārata	The Pāṇḍavas, helped by **Kṛiṣhṇa**, fight their cousins the Kauravas to recover their kingdom	Questions of right and wrong; dharma
Rāmāyaṇa	**Rāma**, with brother **Lakṣhmaṇa** and **Hanuman**, defeats the demon **Rāvaṇa** who kidnapped **Sītā**	Re-establishing dharma

- Both are long Sanskrit **epics** (long poems of heroes' adventures), together ~7,000 pages in the original, with many shorter value-based stories inside.
- For over **two millenniums** they have been translated, adapted and retold across India and Asia. In **Tamil Nadu alone** about 100 folklore versions of the Mahābhārata have been counted.
- Tribal communities (Bhils, Gonds, Mundas, northeast and Himalayan tribes, including Kashmir) have their own versions and legends of the heroes visiting their lands. Example: the **'Pañcha Pāṇḍavar'** stone shrine kept by the **Irula** tribals in the Nilgiris.
- K.S. Singh: 'There is hardly a place in the country which the epic heroes — did not visit according to folklores.' The epics created a dense web of cultural interaction across India and Asia.
- Nehru: villagers, even illiterate, knew hundreds of epic verses by heart.

▸ The Pañchatantra

- Collection of stories with **animals** as main characters, teaching life skills; original Sanskrit text **at least 2,200 years old**.
- Adapted in almost every Indian language and travelled to Southeast Asia, the Arab world and Europe — about **200 adaptations in more than 50 languages**: 'one' collection became 'many'.

> **REMEMBER**
> Classical arts and architecture also show unity and diversity. Indian culture **celebrates diversity as enrichment** but never loses sight of the unity that nourishes it.

8.6 Unity and Diversity at a Glance

Field	Unity	Diversity
Food	Staple grains, common spices	Thousands of regional dishes
Clothing	The sari, the dhoti	Fabrics, weaves, designs, drapes

Field	Unity	Diversity
Festivals	Makara Sankrānti harvest festival	Pongal, Lohri, Bihu, Uttarayan, etc.
Epics	Rāmāyaṇa and Mahābhārata	Hundreds of regional and tribal versions
Literature	Pañchatantra and shared themes	200 adaptations in 50+ languages

Likely question	Model answer
What is meant by unity in diversity?	Many forms and customs coexisting with common underlying elements, values and stories.
What did the People of India project find?	4,635 communities, 325 languages in 25 scripts, and many migrants.
How is food an example of unity in diversity?	Common grains, millets, pulses and spices produce endless varied dishes.
Why is the sari an example?	One unstitched cloth exists in many fabrics, weaves, designs and draping styles.
What is chintz and why was it banned in Europe?	Printed Indian cotton; its popularity hurt European dress sales, so England and France banned imports.
Give one festival example of unity in diversity.	Makara Sankrānti around 14 January is celebrated as Pongal, Lohri, Magh Bihu, Uttarayan, etc.
Briefly state the stories of the two epics.	Mahābhārata: Pāṇḍavas vs Kauravas with Kṛiṣhṇa; Rāmāyaṇa: Rāma defeats Rāvaṇa to rescue Sītā.
How did tribal communities adopt the epics?	They created oral versions and legends of heroes visiting their regions.
What is the Pañchatantra?	An ancient Sanskrit collection of animal stories teaching life skills, adapted worldwide.
What does 'Many in the One' mean?	The many diverse forms of India are expressions of one underlying unity.
Why does diversity enrich rather than divide India?	Because the underlying common values and culture hold the variety together.
Who said India offers 'unity in diversity' as the answer to writing its history?	Historian Vincent Smith.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- India's diversity — people, languages, scripts, dress, food, festivals — is vast.
- A **common core** (staple foods, the sari, harvest festivals, the epics, the Pañchatantra) runs through it.
- The **Rāmāyaṇa and Mahābhārata** exist in countless regional, folk and tribal versions.
- Indian culture **celebrates diversity as enrichment** while remaining united.
- 'Many in the One' is the key phrase of the chapter.

CHAPTER 09 · CIVICS / SOCIETY

Family and Community

The family is the most basic and ancient unit of society, and a community is a larger group of connected people. This chapter looks at family types, relationships and responsibilities, family values (through the stories of Shalini and Tenzing), community cooperation (halma, Chennai floods, Kamal Parmar) and the many meanings of 'community'.

Big Questions

- Why is the family unit important?
- What is a community and what is its role?

9.1 Family

Tiruvalluvar: 'Love and dharma are the flower and fruit of family life.' Almost all of us live in a family — the **fundamental and most ancient unit of any society**.

Type	Who lives together	Notes
Joint family	Several generations — grandparents, parents, uncles, aunts, brothers, sisters, cousins	Shared home, resources and responsibilities
Nuclear family	A couple and their children, sometimes one parent and children	Smaller, often chosen due to modern living (work, space, migration)

▸ Family relationships and language

- English has few kinship terms; **Indian languages have many** — Hindi: *bua, tau, tai, chacha, mausi, nana, nani*; Tamil distinguishes elder and younger brother/sister.
- Most Indian languages have **no word for 'cousin'** — cousins are simply 'brothers' and 'sisters', stressing deep bonds among all children in the family.
- A single Indian-language word often needs several English words (e.g. *chacha* = father's younger brother).

▸ Roles and responsibilities

- Relationships rest on **love, care, cooperation** (working together) and **interdependence**.
- Parents raise children to be happy, responsible members of society; as children grow they take on more responsibilities and learn traditions followed for generations.
- Following **dharma** (doing one's duty) is a key Indian principle. The family is a 'school' for values: **ahimsa, dāna (giving), sevā (service), tyāga (sacrifice)** — members often set aside their own needs for the family's.

Story	Setting	Lesson
Shalini	Town in Kerala; joint family of seven (parents, brother, grandmother *Acchamma*, uncle *Chittappa*, aunt *Chitti*, cousin *Chinni*). Uncle lost his job before **Onam**	Parents bought clothes for the whole family; Shalini accepted a simple cotton dress instead of silk. Families **support each other and share**

Story	Setting	Lesson
Tenzing	Village in Meghalaya; mother in a handicraft cooperative, father runs a grocery and helps at home; grandparents help with stories, homework and social work	Roles are **shared and flexible**; decisions on special expenses are **discussed together**; saving for unexpected needs; grandparents help the neighbourhood

9.2 Community

- Families are connected to other families and people; such a group may be called a **community** (the word has several meanings).
- People come together to celebrate festivals, hold feasts and weddings, and in villages to help each other with farming — land preparation, sowing, harvesting.
- Communities, especially **tribal** ones, agreed on (mostly unwritten) **rules** about shared natural resources — **water, grazing lands, forest produce** — which gave everyone secure access but also gave **duties** to each family.

▸ Communities in action

Example	What happened
Bhil community, Jhabua (Madhya Pradesh)	Facing a severe water crisis, they followed their **halma** tradition (coming together to support anyone in crisis, to serve Mother Earth): planted thousands of trees in hundreds of villages, dug trenches and made water-harvesting structures — unpaid, as a duty. **Mahesh Sharma** of the Shivganga movement received the **Padma Shri in 2019**
Chennai floods, 2015	Roads became rivers and shops closed; many private groups, especially spiritual and religious organisations, cooked and distributed large amounts of food
Kamal Parmar, Ahmedabad (Gujarat)	Owner of a small auto-fabrication workshop, he taught underprivileged children 5:30–9:30 pm and gave free dinner; **150 children** attended; local teachers and school students joined as volunteers — showing service, compassion and the right of all children to education

▸ New and flexible communities

- **Residents' Welfare Associations** (last 30–40 years) in urban areas make their own rules about waste, cleanliness of common areas, pets, etc., with residents participating.
- Communities are **interdependent**: RWAs depend on traders for supplies and municipal workers for waste. Everyone depends on many other people.
- 'Community' is flexible: a **jāti** or its subdivision; a group of a religion, region, work or interest — Mumbai's Parsi community, Chennai's Sikh community, America's Indian community, Kerala's scientific community, the village's farming community; and in school — class, sports, **NSS, NCC**, science or drama clubs.

9.3 Quick Reference

Term	Meaning
Joint family	Many generations and relatives living together
Nuclear family	Couple and children (or one parent and children)
Community	A group of connected people sharing place, work, interest or tradition
Halma	Bhil tradition of coming together to support anyone in crisis and serve Mother Earth

Term	Meaning
RWA	Residents' Welfare Association, a modern urban community making its own rules
Interdependence	People and communities rely on one another

Likely question	Model answer
Why is the family important?	It is the most basic unit of society where members care for each other and children learn values.
Differentiate joint and nuclear families.	Joint: several generations and relatives together; nuclear: couple with children or one parent with children.
Why do most Indian languages lack a word for 'cousin'?	Cousins are called brothers and sisters, showing deep family bonds.
What values does the family teach?	Ahimsa, dāna, sevā, tyāga and dharma (duty).
What does Shalini's story teach?	Families share and support each other, even by giving up personal wants.
What does Tenzing's story show about roles?	Family responsibilities are shared by all members regardless of gender or age, and decisions are made together.
What is a community?	A group of connected people who cooperate for festivals, work, resources and support.
What is halma?	A Bhil tradition of collective help in crisis, as service to Mother Earth.
How did the Bhils tackle water scarcity?	By planting trees and building trenches and water-harvesting structures without payment.
What did Kamal Parmar do?	Ran evening classes and gave free dinner to underprivileged children, and inspired volunteers.
What is an RWA?	An urban community that makes rules about common matters such as waste and cleanliness.
Why are communities interdependent?	No community is self-sufficient; each depends on other people's work and services.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The **family** is the foundation of society; its members support each other with **love, care, cooperation and duty**.
- Families may be **joint or nuclear**; Indian kinship terms reflect strong bonds.
- A **community** is a flexible concept — village, jāti, interest group, RWA, school club.
- Communities cooperate (**halma**, relief in floods, voluntary teaching) and are **interdependent**.
- Shared rules and duties keep communities running smoothly.

CHAPTER 10 · CIVICS

Grassroots Democracy – Part 1: Governance

When many people live together, rules are needed to keep order and harmony. This chapter explains governance and government, the three organs (legislature, executive, judiciary), the three levels (local, State, Centre) and the meaning of democracy, with India as the world's largest representative democracy.

Big Questions

- What is the meaning of 'governance'? Why do we need a government?
- What is the meaning of 'democracy'? Why is it important?

10.1 Why Rules? Governance and Government

- Rules exist at home, school, in exams, on roads and at work. **Without rules society cannot function.**
- **Governance** = the process of taking decisions, organising society's life with rules and ensuring they are followed.
- **Government** = the group of individuals or system that makes the rules and ensures they are followed.
- Important rules are called **laws**. They are not fixed forever — citizens have a say in changing them.
- Government plays a role in public services in everyday life (health, education, roads, water, electricity, safety, post and so on).

NOTE

Mottos: Government of India — *Satyameva Jayate* ('Truth alone triumphs'); Supreme Court — *Yato Dharmastato Jayah* ('Where there is dharma, there is victory'). Mahābhārata: 'The ruler protects dharma and dharma protects those who protect it.'

10.2 Three Organs of Government

Digital technology has changed society — money orders and demand drafts have given way to instant digital payments. It has also created **cybercrime** (stealing money digitally). New laws are made, criminals are caught by the cyber police and courts fine and jail them. Here all three organs act.

Organ	Role	In India (national / State)	In the cybercrime example
Legislature	Makes new laws; updates or removes old ones; an assembly of people's representatives	Parliament (Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha) / State Assembly (Vidhan Sabha); most States have one house, a few have two	Passes laws against cybercrime
Executive	Implements (executes) laws; includes head of state (president, prime minister or chief minister), ministers and law-and-order agencies	Centre: President (nominal head, Supreme Commander of the armed forces) and Prime Minister (real executive head). State: Governor (nominal) and Chief Minister (real)	Cyber police investigate and arrest

Organ	Role	In India (national / State)	In the cybercrime example
Judiciary	System of courts; decides whether the law was broken and the punishment; can check executive decisions and the fairness of laws	Supreme Court / High Courts	Courts convict, fine and jail

IMPORTANT

Separation of powers: the three organs should be kept separate though they interact and cooperate. This gives **checks and balances** — each organ can check the others and restore balance if one oversteps. If all three were controlled by one group, disorder and misuse of power could follow.

DEFINITION

Nominal head — head in name only. The President of India and a State Governor have certain powers in special circumstances but normally do not interfere in the work of the Central or State government.

Level	Examples of functions
Central (national)	Defence, foreign affairs, atomic energy, communications, currency, inter-State commerce, education, national policies
State	Police, law and order, public health, education, agriculture, irrigation, local government; adapting and implementing Central laws in the State
Local	Town and village matters (see Chapters 11 and 12)

(Details of these functions will be studied in Grade 7.)

10.3 Three Levels of Government

- Any government works at **at least two levels** (local and national). **India has three tiers: local, State (regional) and Central/Union.**
- Each level deals with different matters. Analogy: a faulty bulb — check bulb, switch and fuse (local), call an electrician (State), complain to the Electricity Board (national).
- Example — flood: **local authorities** handle a small flood; if several towns and villages are hit, the **State government** sends rescue teams; if vast areas are affected, the **Central government** sends relief, army, etc.

10.4 Democracy

- From Greek **dēmos** = people + **kratos** = rule/power: 'rule of the people'.
- All people cannot rule directly, so they elect **representatives** — **MLAs** (Members of Legislative Assembly) at State level and **MPs** (Members of Parliament) at national level. They discuss laws and problems through dialogue and debate.
- India is a **representative democracy** and the **world's largest democracy** (about **970 million voters in 2024**). All citizens aged **18 and above** can vote.
- A **class monitor** is an example of representation: one elected person speaks for the class.

Type	Meaning	Example
Direct democracy	Every person takes part in the decision	Class votes by raising hands on the picnic place, A or B — the majority wins
Representative democracy	People elect representatives who decide on their behalf	MLAs, MPs, class monitor

DEFINITION

Grassroots democracy — a system that enables and encourages participation of ordinary citizens (the base of the pyramid of the three levels) in decisions affecting them.

NOTE

Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (born 1931, Rameswaram) — 'Missile Man of India'; 11th President (2002–2007). Showed that even a nominal post can make a deep difference through connection with the youth. Quotes: 'Dream is not that which you see while sleeping; it is something that does not let you sleep'; FAIL = First Attempt In Learning; END = Effort Never Dies; NO = Next Opportunity.

10.5 Quick Reference

Likely question	Model answer
What is governance? What is a government?	Governance is deciding and organising society through rules; the government is the system that makes and enforces them.
Why do we need a government?	To make rules and laws, keep order and provide public services so that society can function.
Name the three organs of government and their work.	Legislature makes laws; executive implements them; judiciary decides disputes and punishments.
What is separation of powers?	Keeping the three organs separate so that each can check the others — checks and balances.
Who are the nominal heads of the Centre and States?	The President and the Governor.
Who are the real executive heads?	The Prime Minister at the Centre and the Chief Minister in a State.
Name the two houses of Parliament.	Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha.
Why does India have three levels of government?	Different matters are best handled at local, State and national levels.
What does democracy mean?	Rule of the people (dēmos + kratos).
Distinguish direct and representative democracy.	In direct democracy everyone decides; in representative democracy elected representatives decide.
Who can vote in India?	All citizens aged 18 and above.
What is grassroots democracy?	Democracy that involves ordinary citizens in decisions affecting them.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Governance** needs rules; the **government** makes and enforces them; **laws** are key rules.
- Three organs — **legislature, executive, judiciary** — work separately with **checks and balances**.
- India has **three levels**: local, State and Centre.
- **Democracy** means rule of the people, exercised through **elected representatives** (MLAs, MPs).
- India is the **world's largest democracy**; voting age is **18**.

CHAPTER 11 · CIVICS

Grassroots Democracy – Part 2: Local Government in Rural Areas

India has about 600,000 villages and nearly two-thirds of its people live in rural areas, so villages need a government close to them. This chapter explains the three-tier Panchayati Raj system, the Gram Sabha and Gram Panchayat, inspiring Sarpanchs, child-friendly panchayats and Kauṭilya's ancient village-to-province administration.

Big Questions

- What are Panchayati Raj institutions? What are their functions?
- Why are they important in governance and democracy?

11.1 Why Local Government in Villages?

- India has about **600,000 villages, 8,000 towns and over 4,000 cities**; population over **1.4 billion**, almost **two-thirds rural**. 'The real India lives in its villages' — Gandhi.
- Case village: **Lakshmanpur**, foothills of the Himalayas, 200 houses, ~700 people, mostly farmers. Needs: water for fields, road repair, primary school upkeep, resolving land disputes and thefts. People cannot run to the State or national capital for every issue.
- Hence the system of local self-government called the **Panchayat** ('village council'), also called **Panchayati Raj**.

DEFINITION

Panchayati Raj — a form of **self-government** that brings governance closer to people, helps them take part in decisions, addresses local issues, promotes development and ensures government schemes reach the grassroots.

11.2 The Three-Tier System

Level	Institution (names vary)	Role
Village	**Gram Panchayat** (Village Parishad)	Closest to people; directly elected; manages village affairs
Block	**Panchayat Samiti** / Block Panchayat / Mandal Parishad	Link between Gram Panchayat and Zila Parishad; coordinates development plans of the panchayats
District	**Zila Parishad** / District Panchayat	Top tier; coordinates and presents district-level plans

Together they cover agriculture, housing, roads, water resources, education, health care, social welfare and cultural activities.

▸ Gram Panchayat

- Members are elected by the **Gram Sabha** — all adults of a village (or neighbouring villages) enrolled as voters; women and men discuss all local matters and decide.
- The head is the **Sarpanch** (or **Pradhan**); more and more women are now Sarpanchs.

- Assisted by the **Panchayat Secretary** (calls meetings, keeps records) and the **Patwari** (keeps land records, sometimes generations-old maps — useful for understanding past and present land use).

Sarpanch	Achievement
Dnyaneshwar Kamble	Transgender Sarpanch of Tarangfal (Solapur, Maharashtra), elected 2017 defeating six candidates; motto *lok seva, gram seva*
Vandana Bahadur Maida	Bhil woman, first female Sarpanch of Khankhandvi (Madhya Pradesh); brought women to Sabha meetings, tackled education and sanitation
Popatrao Baguji Pawar	Hiware Bazar (Ahmednagar, Maharashtra): used Anna Hazare's model — rainwater harvesting, watershed conservation, lakhs of trees — turning a drought-hit village green; **Padma Shri 2020**

11.3 Children and Panchayats

- **Child-Friendly Panchayat Initiative:** children's views are heard through **Bal Sabhas and Bal Panchayats**. In Maharashtra, Bal Panchayats have worked against child labour and child marriage and brought children back to school.
- **Sangkhu Radhu Khandu Gram Panchayat (West Sikkim):** built school compound walls and school kitchens for hygienic midday meals — declared child-friendly.
- **Children's Parliament (Rajasthan):** offshoot of Bunker Roy's **Barefoot College**; children aged 8–14 in night schools held parliament-style elections with voter ID cards, formed a 'Cabinet' to oversee school management and community needs; won the **World's Children's Honorary Award, 2001**.

11.4 Panchayat Samiti and Zila Parishad

- Composition differs across States, but role is the same. **Members** are elected locally and may include Sarpanchs of the area and local MLAs.
- They **coordinate** matters across Gram Panchayats: collect development plans from all and present them at higher levels, helping with **allotment of funds** and schemes such as **Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana** (all-weather rural roads).
- At all three levels there are special provisions for **disadvantaged sections** and **one-third of seats reserved for women**.
- States have authority over panchayats, so structure and functions vary a little, but all aim at active **participation of villagers** in managing local development.

11.5 Kauṭilya's Arthaśhāstra

- Written ~**2,300 years ago** by **Kauṭilya** (Chāṇakya): structure of the state, prosperous economy, duties of the ruler, war.
- Administrative plan: **sangrahaṇa** for every 10 villages (sub-district HQ); **kārvaṭika** for 100 villages (district HQ); **droṇamukha** for 400 villages; **sthānīya** for 800 villages (provincial HQ) — comparable to our block, district and province structure.

11.6 Quick Reference

Likely question	Model answer
What is a Panchayat?	The village council, the basic local self-government in rural India.

Likely question	Model answer
Name the three tiers of Panchayati Raj.	Gram Panchayat (village), Panchayat Samiti (block), Zila Parishad (district).
What is the Gram Sabha?	Assembly of all adult voters of a village that discusses local matters and elects the Gram Panchayat.
Who heads the Gram Panchayat?	The Sarpanch or Pradhan.
Who are the Panchayat Secretary and Patwari?	The secretary handles administration and records; the Patwari keeps land records.
Why are Panchayats important?	They bring governance closer to people, enable participation, and help development reach the grassroots.
What reservation exists for women?	One-third of seats at all three tiers.
Role of the Panchayat Samiti?	Link between Gram Panchayat and Zila Parishad; coordinates and forwards development plans.
What is a Bal Panchayat?	A children's panchayat where children voice their concerns.
How did Hiware Bazar change?	Under Sarpanch Popatrao Pawar, water harvesting and tree planting made it green and prosperous.
What is PM Gram Sadak Yojana?	A scheme for all-weather roads in rural areas.
What did Kauṭilya propose?	An administrative hierarchy from sangrahaṇa (10 villages) to sthānīya (800 villages).

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Villages are governed through the three-tier **Panchayati Raj**: Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad.
- The **Gram Sabha** elects the Gram Panchayat headed by a **Sarpanch**.
- Democracy works through **direct participation and elected representatives**, with **one-third reservation for women**.
- Children are involved through Bal Panchayats and child-friendly initiatives.
- Panchayati Raj gives rural people **self-governance** and a say in development.

CHAPTER 12 · CIVICS

Grassroots Democracy – Part 3: Local Government in Urban Areas

Urban areas are larger, busier and more diverse than villages, so urban governance is more complex — yet it works on the same principle of participatory democracy. This chapter explains urban local bodies, wards and ward committees, the three types of urban bodies by population, their functions and funds, and the duties of citizens.

Big Questions

- What are urban local bodies and what are their functions?
- Why are they important in governance and democracy?

12.1 Participatory Democracy in Cities

- In a democracy, good governance empowers citizens to **participate** at every level — rural, regional, urban, State, national. This is **participatory democracy**.
- Cities like Kolkata, Chennai and Mumbai are more complex and diverse than villages, so urban governance is more elaborate.
- The governance pyramid: **Union government → State government → Local government**. Local government has two sides: **rural (Panchayati Raj Institutions)** and **urban (Urban Local Bodies)**. The base is the people, closest to local government.
- Rustom K. Sidhwa in the Constituent Assembly (13 October 1949) argued for full-fledged local bodies so people learn what administration, franchise, powers and rights mean 'in their own town'.

12.2 Urban Local Bodies

- Local government structures in urban areas are called **urban local bodies**. They are **decentralised** — instead of orders from a central authority at the top, local communities have a direct say in how their areas are managed.
- Cities and towns are divided into smaller units called **wards**, with **ward committees** and the people of the ward at the base.
- **Ward committees:** organise health camps, campaigns against single-use plastics, watch for problems — water leaks, blocked drains, damaged roads — and report them. Working differs from State to State.
- Members are **elected** to represent citizens, as in the Panchayati Raj.

Functions of urban local bodies
Looking after infrastructure (roads, drains, water)
Garbage collection and disposal; solid waste management
Maintaining burial grounds / cremation grounds
Checking implementation of government schemes
Collecting local taxes and fines
Planning for economic and social development of the area

IMPORTANT

Citizens have **duties** too: follow instructions on waste segregation, report water leaks and damage promptly, show care for their area. Efficient local government needs participation.

12.3 Types of Urban Local Bodies

Population of city / town	Highest body	Other names
Above 10 lakh	**Municipal Corporation**	Mahanagar Nigam
1 to 10 lakh	**Municipal Council**	Nagar Palika
Smaller towns	**Nagar Panchayat**	City Council / Town Council

▸ Case studies

City	Highlights
Madras (Chennai) Corporation	Established **29 September 1688** — the oldest municipal institution in India. The East India Company's charter (the previous year) made the town of Fort St. George and territory within **16 km** a corporation. The **Parliamentary Act of 1792** gave power to levy municipal taxes — municipal administration properly began
Bombay Municipal Corporation (now Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai)	Created in **1865**
Indore Municipal Corporation	Services: property tax, water charges, solid waste management, business/trade licences, marriage certificates, fire services, grievances, tree cutting permits, on-request services (water tanker, septic tanker, auditorium, funeral van, mobile toilet, ambulance). **Citizen Relationship Management (CRM)** helps citizens. Indore has been the **cleanest city of India under Swachh Survekshan for seven years in a row**, thanks to citizens' cooperation

Funds: urban local bodies earn from property tax, water charges, licences and fees, fines and paid services (tankers, auditorium hire, ambulance, etc.), and grants from higher governments.

12.4 Village and City: A Comparison

Aspect	Rural (Panchayati Raj)	Urban local bodies
Base	Gram Sabha	Ward / people of the ward, ward committee
Tiers / types	Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad	Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council, Municipal Corporation
Basis of type	Village, block, district	Population of the town / city
Head	Sarpanch / Pradhan	Elected head of the body (e.g. Mayor in a corporation)
Community	Everyone knows everyone; wider direct participation	Busy, crowded, anonymous; still community spirit in crises

Aspect	Rural (Panchayati Raj)	Urban local bodies
Principle	Elected representatives, participation, decentralisation	Same

NOTE

Sameer and Anita's conversation: in villages everybody knows each other and even kids get heard (they got a low-hanging wire fixed through the Gram Sabha); in cities people are more independent but neighbours still help in emergencies (e.g. a collapsed house) and local bodies with elected representatives help. 'It seems more complicated in the city, but the idea is the same — everyone's voice matters.'

12.5 Quick Reference

Likely question	Model answer
What is an urban local body?	A local government institution for a town or city, with elected representatives.
What does decentralised mean?	Power is shared with local communities instead of resting with a central authority at the top.
What is a ward and a ward committee?	A ward is a smaller unit of a city; the ward committee organises activities and reports problems.
Name the three types of urban local bodies.	Municipal Corporation, Municipal Council (Nagar Palika) and Nagar Panchayat.
Which cities get a Municipal Corporation?	Those with a population above 10 lakh.
List five functions of urban local bodies.	Infrastructure, garbage collection, burial grounds, scheme implementation, tax collection, development planning.
Which is the oldest municipal institution in India?	The Madras (now Greater Chennai) Corporation, established 29 September 1688.
What made Indore the cleanest city?	Efficient solid waste management by the Corporation together with citizens' cooperation.
What duties do citizens have?	Segregating waste, reporting leaks and damage, caring for common areas.
How do urban local bodies raise money?	Taxes, fees for services, fines and grants.
Compare Panchayati Raj and urban local bodies.	Both are elected, decentralised local governments; rural has three tiers by area, urban has three types by population.
What is participatory democracy?	A system where citizens actively take part in governance at every level.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Urban areas are governed by **decentralised urban local bodies** with elected members.
- Cities are divided into **wards** with **ward committees**.
- Bodies are: **Municipal Corporation (above 10 lakh), Municipal Council (1–10 lakh), Nagar Panchayat (smaller)**.
- Functions include **infrastructure, waste, burial grounds, taxes, schemes and planning**.
- Good governance needs **citizens' duties** — participatory democracy in cities as in villages.

CHAPTER 13 · ECONOMICS

The Value of Work

People do many kinds of work every day — some for money and some out of love, care or service. This chapter distinguishes economic from non-economic activities, shows how people are paid (salary, wage, fee, payment in kind), explains value addition and highlights the importance of sevā and community participation.

Big Questions

- What are the different types of activities that people engage in?
- What is their contribution to our everyday lives?

13.1 Economic and Non-Economic Activities

Anu and Kabir see that everyone around them does many things: Geeta Aunty is an Indian Air Force pilot (salary); Kabir's grandfather, a retired BSF officer, tends the garden, runs errands and teaches Geography free; Anu's parents run a uniform and garment shop, and her mother teaches knitting voluntarily; her brother Rohan is a software engineer (salary) who volunteers teaching computer skills on weekends.

	Economic activities	Non-economic activities
Meaning	Involve **money or money's worth**; done in exchange for money or its equivalent	Do **not generate income or wealth**; done from gratitude, love, care and respect
Examples	Business person selling school bags; farmer selling produce; lawyer earning a fee; truck driver carrying goods; factory workers; pilot on salary; Rohan's software job	Parents cooking for the family or helping with homework; youth caring for grandparents; family renovating the home; Rohan teaching computers free; grandfather teaching neighbourhood kids
Return	Salary, wage, fee, profit, payment in kind	Satisfaction, gratitude, well-being, stronger relationships

NOTE

The **same person** can do both: Rohan earns a salary at his company (economic) and volunteers at weekends (non-economic). A teacher teaching for a salary is economic; teaching the same lesson free is non-economic.

Terms: *market* — place where goods and services are exchanged (mostly for money); *fee* — payment for professional advice or service (doctor, lawyer); *money's worth* — the monetary value of an object based on the benefit it gives; *salary* — fixed regular (monthly) payment by an employer.

13.2 Types of Economic Activities and Ways of Payment

From Kavya's visit to the village Kamlapur:

Person	Work	Payment
Kavya's uncle	Bulldozer technician in a construction company (highway under construction; will cut travel time from 5 hours to 2)	Monthly **salary**

Person	Work	Payment
Kavya's aunt	Employee at the village post office; also online classes for exam preparation	Monthly **salary**; weekly **fee**
Sahil	Farm labourer driving a tractor on a farmer's land	Daily **wage** — partly cash, partly **mangoes** (**payment in kind**)
Rajesh	Carpenter making furniture	Income from **selling** furniture

Form of payment	Meaning	Example
Salary	Fixed regular payment, usually monthly, by an employer	Pilot, software engineer, post-office employee
Wage	Payment by employer for a specific period of work (often daily)	Farm labourer
Fee	Payment for professional advice or service	Doctor, lawyer, online tutor
Payment in kind	Non-cash payment for work done	Mangoes to Sahil
Sale income / profit	Money earned by selling goods	Shopkeeper, farmer, carpenter

13.3 Value Addition

> DEFINITION
> **Value addition** — economic activities add value at each stage of transforming something into another form.

Example: carpenter Rajesh buys wood for **₹600**, uses tools and materials and makes a chair sold for **₹1,000**. The extra **₹400** (1,000 − 600) is the value of his **skill, time and effort**. He has added value to the wood by making it furniture. Buying and selling both involve payment, so all are economic activities.

Activity	Creates monetary value?
Baker, tailor, doctor, scientist	Yes
Farmers repairing their own tractor	Yes, helps income (production) — repair is part of farming
Parents cooking dinner for the family	No (non-economic)
Caring for a sick grandparent	No (non-economic)

13.4 Importance of Non-Economic Activities

- They create no money but bring great value: satisfaction, gratitude and contribution to society without expecting anything in return.
- **Sevā** = selfless service. Seen in temples, gurudwaras, mosques and churches — e.g. **langar** (community kitchen) at gurudwaras (Golden Temple) serves free food to every visitor; temples distribute **prasād**.
- **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan** — collective effort of citizens to keep surroundings clean (homes, streets, parks); individual efforts add up to a clean neighbourhood and nation.
- **Van Mahotsav** (festival of forests) — community tree-plantation drives to promote awareness of trees and conservation of forests.

- Festivals involve community members decorating, cooking and sharing — non-economic but valuable.
- Non-economic activities contribute to **social welfare, personal well-being** and a better **quality of life**.

> **REMEMBER**
> Vivekananda: do any work as worship — with full devotion. Both kinds of work matter: economic activities earn a living; non-economic activities build a caring society.

13.5 Quick Reference

Likely question	Model answer
Define economic activities with examples.	Activities done for money or money's worth — a farmer selling produce, a lawyer taking fees, factory workers.
Define non-economic activities with examples.	Activities without income, done from love, care or gratitude — cooking for family, caring for grandparents.
Can the same activity be economic and non-economic?	Yes — teaching for a salary is economic; teaching free as a volunteer is non-economic.
What is the difference between salary and wage?	Salary is a fixed regular (monthly) payment; wage is payment for a specific period of work, often daily.
What is payment in kind?	Non-cash payment for work, e.g. mangoes given to Sahil.
What is a fee?	Payment for professional services such as a doctor's or lawyer's.
What is value addition?	The increase in value as a good is transformed through skill, time and effort.
Explain value addition with the carpenter example.	Wood costing ₹600 becomes a chair sold for ₹1,000; the extra ₹400 is Rajesh's added value.
What is sevā?	Selfless service without expecting anything in return, e.g. langar.
Give two examples of community participation.	Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and Van Mahotsav.
Why do non-economic activities matter?	They support social welfare, personal well-being and a better quality of life.
Is a traditional festival gathering economic?	Mostly non-economic, but it holds social value through togetherness.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Activities are **economic** (for money or money's worth) or **non-economic** (for love, care, service).
- People are paid through **salary, wage, fee, sale income and payment in kind**.
- Economic activities create **value addition** (e.g. ₹600 wood → ₹1,000 chair).
- Non-economic activities such as **sevā, Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and Van Mahotsav** strengthen society.
- Both types of work are valuable for a good life.

CHAPTER 14 · ECONOMICS

Economic Activities Around Us

Economic activities have multiplied from farming, pottery and weaving to computers, banking and software. To understand how they work and link with each other, they are classified into three sectors — primary, secondary and tertiary — which depend on one another, as the AMUL dairy cooperative and the making of a textbook show.

Big Questions

- How are economic activities classified?
- What differentiates these activities to be grouped into sectors?
- How are the three sectors interconnected?

14.1 Classifying Economic Activities

- Economic activities create **monetary value** (value measurable in money). Earlier most people did agriculture, livestock rearing, making tools, pottery and weaving; today there are countless activities — manufacturing computers, mobiles and drones, banking, teaching, driving vehicles, tailoring, software, repairing appliances.
- Activities with similar characteristics are grouped into **economic sectors** — broad groups of activities that help a nation's economic prosperity. The three: **primary, secondary and tertiary**.
- Kauṭilya's Arthaśhāstra: 'The root of prosperity is economic activity.'

Sector	Nature	Examples
Primary	People depend **directly on nature** to produce goods; extraction of **raw materials**	Agriculture, mining, fishing, livestock rearing, forestry, poultry, greenhouse farming, fish farming
Secondary	**Processing** primary-sector outputs into other products; construction and utilities; manufacturing	Flour mills, oil from groundnut, tea processing, furniture and paper from wood, clothes from cotton, steel and automobiles, textile and pharmaceutical factories, construction, water supply, electricity, solar power
Tertiary (service sector)	**Services** that support primary and secondary activities and people	Healthcare, trade and logistics, communication, banking, transportation, teaching, law, hotels, restaurants, software, repair, airports, warehouses, retail shops

14.2 The Three Sectors in Detail

▸ A. Primary sector

- Extraction of raw materials directly from nature: grains and vegetables from farms, wood from forests, coal from mines, fish from fisheries, eggs from poultry farms.
- The most common: agriculture, mining, fishing, raising livestock, forestry.

▸ B. Secondary sector

- Depends on primary outputs and **transforms** them, in factories and production units, into products for sale or use.

- Includes **construction** of buildings and roads and **utilities** — water, electricity, gas.
- Examples: grain → flour; groundnut → oil; tea leaves → tea; wood → furniture and paper; cotton → clothes; iron ore → steel → cars and trucks.

> NOTE
> **Automobile production in India, 2022** (SIAM): passenger vehicles about 45 lakh; commercial vehicles 10.3 lakh; three-wheelers 8.6 lakh; two-wheelers about 2 crore.

▸ C. Tertiary sector

- Provides **services** that support those in primary and secondary activities — sometimes unseen but vital. A truck driver carries grain and vegetables from farm to factory or market.
- Vendors sell produce to households; doctors, nurses, teachers, lawyers, pilots serve people; technicians and mechanics repair phones, TVs, cars, tractors; electricians keep power on; communication, software, hotels, banks, schools, hospitals, airports, shops, warehouses.
- Also called the **service sector**. **Warehouse** = large building for storing products before sale.

14.3 Interdependence of Sectors: AMUL

Problem before 1946
In the 1940s farmers of Anand (Gujarat) sold milk to nearby villages, walking or cycling in the heat. Milk spoils fast, so they sold in a hurry or to **middlemen** who bought in bulk at low prices; farmers felt cheated and harassed.

Advice of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
The farmers approached him; he advised them to form a **cooperative** to become independent of middlemen and manage collection, processing and distribution themselves.

AMUL set up, 1946
Anand Milk Union Limited (AMUL) was set up under **Tribhuvandas Patel** (lawyer and freedom fighter) and **Dr Verghese Kurien** (engineer). Farmers, including women, jointly decided on production, pasteurisation and sale; income rose and middlemen were no longer needed.

Growth
A factory was set up in Anand to make butter and milk powder; today many processing plants across India produce a wide range of products, sold in retail shops and exported.

Sector mapping
Milking cows and selling milk = **primary**. Processing milk into milk powder, ghee, cheese, butter in factories = **secondary**. Transport by trucks, rail, air and ship, trading and retail stores = **tertiary**.

> DEFINITION
> **Cooperative** — a group of people who voluntarily come together to meet economic and social needs in a formal way; they own it and decide collectively. **Middlemen** — buy from producers and sell to consumers for a fee. **Pasteurisation** — heating milk to a specific temperature to kill harmful bacteria. **Retail** — sale of goods in small quantities to the final consumer. **Export** — goods sold to another country.

Other milk cooperatives: **Nandini** (Karnataka), **Mother Dairy** (Delhi-NCR), **Aavin** (Tamil Nadu), **Vijaya** (Andhra Pradesh), **Kevi** (Nagaland), **Sudha** (Bihar), **Verka** (Punjab).

▸ From tree to textbook

- **Primary:** trees are cut to obtain wood pulp. **Secondary:** pulp is converted into paper, which is printed and bound into books. **Tertiary:** transport, distribution, sale, and services such as designing and

publishing.

- None of this would be possible unless all three sectors work together.
- **Recycling** one tonne of paper saves **17 trees** and **2.5 cubic metres** of landfill space, and uses **70% less energy and water** than making paper from pulp. Use paper judiciously.

14.4 Comparison and Quick Reference

Feature	Primary	Secondary	Tertiary
Meaning	Extracting raw materials from nature	Processing raw materials into finished goods	Providing services
Dependence	Depends on natural resources	Depends on primary sector	Supports primary and secondary sectors
Examples	Farming, fishing, mining	Mills, factories, construction	Banking, transport, teaching
AMUL	Milking cows	Making butter, powder	Transport and retail

Likely question	Model answer
Why are economic activities classified into sectors?	To understand how they function and how they are linked.
Define the primary sector with two examples.	Activities that extract raw materials directly from nature, e.g. farming and mining.
What is the secondary sector?	Activities that process primary outputs into products, plus construction and utilities, e.g. flour mills, factories.
Why is the tertiary sector called the service sector?	Because it provides services that support primary and secondary activities.
How does the secondary sector depend on the tertiary sector?	It needs transport, banking, electricity services, marketing and repair to run and sell goods.
Why did farmers of Anand form a cooperative?	To avoid middlemen who paid low prices and to control milk collection, processing and sale.
Who advised the farmers and who led AMUL?	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel advised; Tribhuvandas Patel and Dr Verghese Kurien led.
What is a cooperative?	A voluntary group that owns and manages an economic enterprise collectively.
Classify milking, making butter and trucking milk.	Primary, secondary and tertiary respectively.
How are the three sectors involved in making a textbook?	Wood pulp from trees (primary), paper and printing (secondary), transport and sale (tertiary).
Why is recycling paper beneficial?	Saves trees, landfill space, energy and water.
Name two other milk cooperatives.	Nandini (Karnataka), Aavin (Tamil Nadu), Mother Dairy, Sudha, Verka and others.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Economic activities are grouped into **primary, secondary and tertiary** sectors.
- **Primary** = raw materials from nature; **secondary** = processing and manufacturing; **tertiary** = services.
- The three sectors are **interdependent** — AMUL and the textbook show how all work together.
- **Cooperatives** like AMUL give producers control and remove middlemen.
- Recycling and judicious use of resources help sustain economic life.